SECTION A – 2 MARKS

Q1.

Personality is the set of behaviours, thoughts, emotions and habits that make a person unique. It reflects how a person reacts, communicates, thinks and presents themselves in different situations, and it is shaped by heredity, environment and situation.

Q2.

SWOT analysis is a personal analysis tool that studies one's Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities and Threats. It helps a person understand themselves better and plan personal and career development.

Q3.

Self-awareness is the ability to understand your own personality, emotions, behaviour, strengths and weaknesses. It helps in setting realistic goals and in knowing how others see you.

Q4.

1. **Pomodoro technique:** Study or work for 25 minutes, then take a 5-minute break.
2. **To-do list:** Prioritise tasks with a to-do list and follow a daily plan or schedule.

Q5.

Procrastination is the habit of delaying important tasks, often by doing easier or less important activities. It is caused by fear of failure, lack of motivation, feeling overwhelmed and distractions.

Q6.

Self-monitoring is the ability to observe and control one's own behaviour, emotions and appearance in different situations to fit social expectations. It means paying attention to how you act and how others react, and adjusting your behaviour if needed.

Q7.

Perception is the process of interpreting and understanding the information received through the senses. In simple words, it is how we see, understand and make sense of the world around us.

Q8.

1. **Positive attitude:** Optimistic, hopeful and open-minded.
2. **Negative attitude:** Pessimistic, doubtful and resistant to change.

Q9.

Assertive communication is expressing your thoughts, feelings and needs confidently and respectfully, without being aggressive or passive. It means standing up for yourself in a calm and honest way, using polite but firm language.

Q10.

Basis	Passive behaviour	Aggressive behaviour
Meaning	Avoids expressing needs or opinions	Forceful, disrespectful communication
Example	Not speaking up even when treated unfairly	Yelling or threatening to get one's way

Q11.

1. **Clear vision and strong communication:** The leader knows the goal and explains it clearly to the team.
2. **Integrity and honesty:** The leader is fair and truthful, so people trust and follow them.

Q12.

Negotiation is the process where two or more people discuss and reach an agreement that benefits all parties. It is a way of solving problems or making deals by talking and compromising.

Q13.

Conflict management is the process of handling disagreements or arguments between individuals or groups in a peaceful and constructive way. It uses techniques such as compromising and collaborating to find a solution instead of blaming.

Q14.

1. **Low:** Isolated incidents such as minor misunderstandings that are easily resolved.
2. **Medium:** Frequent or persistent disagreements that start to affect relationships or productivity.
3. **High:** Serious fights, ongoing tension or hostility that need significant intervention.

Q15.

Transactional analysis (TA) is a psychological method, developed by Dr. Eric Berne, that studies interactions (transactions) between people based on their behaviour and communication. It explains these interactions through the Parent, Adult and Child ego states.

Q16.

1. **I'm OK – You're OK:** The healthy position.
2. **I'm OK – You're not OK:** The dominating position.
3. **I'm not OK – You're OK:** Low self-esteem.
4. **I'm not OK – You're not OK:** A negative mindset.

Q17.

Emotional intelligence (EI) is the ability to understand, manage and express your own emotions, and to recognise and influence the emotions of others. In simple words, it means being smart with your feelings.

Q18.

1. **Physical:** Headaches, tiredness and sleep problems.
2. **Emotional:** Anxiety, sadness and anger.

Q19.

A **video resume** is a short video in which a candidate introduces themselves and highlights their skills. It adds value to a job application and can be made with apps such as Canva, Biteable, InVideo or an unlisted YouTube video.

Q20.

1. **Use polite language:** Be polite in emails, messages and posts, and avoid writing in all capital letters (it looks like shouting).
2. **Respect privacy:** Respect others' privacy online and do not spread fake news or offensive content.

Q21.

The **STAR technique** is a method of answering behavioural interview questions in four parts: Situation, Task, Action and Result. The candidate explains what happened, what had to be done, what they did and what the result was.

Q22.

1. **Confidence:** Speaking up clearly and without fear.
2. **Active listening:** Listening to others and respecting their views.

SECTION B – 5 MARKS

Q1.

1. **Meaning:** Personality is the set of behaviours, thoughts, emotions and habits that make a person unique; it is shaped by heredity, environment and situation.
2. **Heredity:** Traits inherited from parents, such as body structure, intelligence and temperament. Example: a child may have the calm temperament of a parent.
3. **Family environment:** Upbringing, values and habits learnt at home shape how a person thinks and behaves.
4. **Social and cultural environment:** School, peer groups, media and culture influence a person's attitudes, language and behaviour. Example: a student in an active college club grows more confident.

5. **Situation:** Behaviour may change with the situation. Example: someone may be quiet at home but confident in a classroom or office.

Q2.

Self-awareness is the ability to understand your own personality, emotions, behaviour, strengths and weaknesses.

1. **Realistic goals and better decisions:** Knowing your strengths and weaknesses helps you set achievable goals and improves decision-making and emotional control.
2. **Stronger relationships:** It builds better relationships and helps you understand how others perceive you.
3. **Self-reflection and a journal:** Think about your own actions and keep a personal diary or journal.
4. **Feedback from others:** Ask teachers, friends and colleagues for honest feedback and act on it.
5. **Personality assessment tools:** Use tools such as MBTI or the Johari Window. Example: if you get nervous during public speaking, practise in small groups to build confidence.

Q3.

Goal setting is the process of identifying something you want to achieve and making a plan to reach it.

1. **Importance:** It gives clarity and direction, increases motivation and focus, helps measure progress and encourages discipline and planning.
2. **Specific and Measurable:** The goal must be clear and well-defined, and its progress must be trackable.
3. **Achievable:** The goal must be realistic and possible with the time and ability you have.
4. **Relevant and Time-bound:** It must match your personal or career goals and have a fixed deadline.
5. **Example and tips:** "I will improve my spoken English by practising 30 minutes daily for 3 months." Write goals down, break them into small steps and review progress regularly.

Q4.

Perceptual errors are mistakes we make while judging people or situations, because we interpret information wrongly.

1. **Stereotyping:** Judging someone based on their group identity. Example: thinking all teenagers are lazy.
2. **Halo effect:** Forming a whole opinion from one good quality. Example: thinking someone is intelligent just because they speak well.
3. **Horn effect:** Judging someone negatively because of one bad quality. Example: thinking a late-comer is careless in all work.
4. **Other errors:** First impression error (quick judgement without the full picture) and projection (assuming others think and feel as you do).
5. **Avoiding errors:** Be aware of your own biases, avoid jumping to conclusions, collect more information before judging and keep an open mind.

Q5.

Attitude is a mental state involving beliefs, feelings and behaviour towards a person, object or situation.

1. **Formation:** Attitudes are formed by family and upbringing, personal experiences, peer influence, media and culture, and education.
2. **Types:** Positive (optimistic, hopeful, open-minded), negative (pessimistic, doubtful, resistant to change) and neutral (neither strongly positive nor negative).
3. **Barriers to change:** Strong beliefs or habits, peer pressure, fear of change and lack of awareness or motivation.
4. **Education, information and experience:** Learning new facts or perspectives, and direct involvement, can change views.
5. **Communication and positive reinforcement:** Persuasion by trusted sources and rewards for better behaviour. Example: a student who feared public speaking develops a positive attitude after a successful class presentation.

Q6.

Basis	Assertive	Passive	Aggressive
Meaning	Honest and respectful communication	Avoids expressing needs or opinions	Forceful, disrespectful communication
Respect	Respects self and others	Respects others, not self	Respects self, not others
Language and tone	Polite but firm, calm voice	Hesitant, soft, apologetic	Loud, blaming, threatening
Body language	Eye contact and good posture	Avoids eye contact	Stares, points fingers
Example	Calmly expressing disagreement	Not speaking up even when treated unfairly	Yelling or threatening to get one's way

Q7.

Team building is the process of creating a group of individuals who work together effectively to achieve common goals.

1. **Importance:** It encourages cooperation and trust, improves communication, increases productivity and creativity, reduces conflicts and builds a sense of belonging.
2. **Formal teams:** Created by an organisation with a clear structure and goals. Example: a project team in a company.
3. **Informal teams:** Formed naturally by people with common interests. Example: friends working together on a college event.
4. **Cross-functional teams:** Members from different departments. Example: marketing, finance and HR working together.
5. **Virtual teams:** Teams that work online or remotely. Example: a remote customer support team.

Q8.

1. **Autocratic and democratic:** An autocratic leader takes decisions alone (military); a democratic leader involves the team in decisions (a project leader who takes suggestions).
2. **Laissez-faire:** The leader gives freedom to team members. Example: creative industries such as advertising or design.
3. **Transformational and transactional:** A transformational leader inspires and brings change; a transactional leader rewards or punishes based on performance (a sales manager giving bonuses for targets).
4. **Qualities of an effective leader:** Clear vision and strong communication, confidence and decision-making, empathy and emotional intelligence, integrity and honesty, and the ability to motivate others.
5. **21st-century competencies:** Agility (quick, flexible decisions), empathy (understanding others' feelings), adaptability (adjusting to change and uncertainty) and technological awareness (using digital tools to lead).

Q9.

Negotiation is the process where two or more people discuss and reach an agreement that benefits all parties.

1. **Preparation:** Know your goals, the facts and the other party's needs.
2. **Opening:** Start the discussion politely and professionally.
3. **Discussion:** Share ideas, offers and concerns, and listen actively.
4. **Bargaining:** Make offers and find compromises, focusing on interests, not positions, to create a win-win result.
5. **Closing and implementation:** Agree on the final terms and follow through on the agreement.

Q10.

1. **Intrapersonal and interpersonal:** Conflict within oneself (confusion about choosing a career) and conflict between two people (a disagreement between classmates).

2. **Intragroup and intergroup:** Conflict within a team (members not agreeing on a plan) and between two groups (two departments arguing over project control).
3. **Low level:** Isolated incidents such as minor misunderstandings or differences of opinion that are easily resolved and leave no lasting tension.
4. **Medium level:** Frequent or persistent issues, such as regular disagreements or ongoing communication breakdowns, that start to affect relationships or productivity.
5. **High level:** Serious fights, ongoing tension, hostility or harmful situations that need significant intervention to resolve.

Q11.

Communication is the process of exchanging information, ideas, thoughts and feelings between people through words, symbols or actions.

1. **Sender and message:** The sender starts the communication; the message is the information to be shared.
2. **Medium and receiver:** The medium is the method used (spoken, written, digital); the receiver gets and understands the message.
3. **Feedback and noise:** Feedback is the receiver's response; noise is any physical or emotional disturbance that affects the message.
4. **Barriers:** Language differences, cultural misunderstandings, emotional disturbances, poor listening and physical distractions such as noise or poor internet.
5. **Overcoming barriers:** Use simple and clear language, listen actively, avoid assumptions and clarify doubts, choose the right medium and be culturally sensitive.

Q12.

The **Johari Window** is a model to improve self-awareness and communication, which divides what is known about a person into four areas.

1. **Open area:** Known to self and to others.
2. **Hidden area:** Known to self but not to others.
3. **Blind spot:** Unknown to self but known to others.
4. **Unknown area:** Unknown to self and to others.
5. **Relevance to personal development:** Sharing about yourself reduces the hidden area and asking for feedback reduces the blind spot, so the open area grows, which builds self-awareness, trust and better communication.

Q13.

Emotional intelligence (EI) is the ability to understand, manage and express your own emotions, and to recognise and influence the emotions of others.

1. **Self-awareness:** Knowing your own emotions.
2. **Self-regulation:** Controlling your emotions and pausing before reacting.
3. **Motivation:** Staying positive and driven.
4. **Empathy:** Understanding others' feelings.
5. **Social skills:** Communicating and managing relationships. Example: a team leader who stays calm in a crisis and motivates the team.

Q14.

Stress is the physical or emotional pressure a person feels when overwhelmed by demands or challenges.

1. **Time management:** Plan your schedule and avoid last-minute work.
2. **Exercise and a healthy lifestyle:** Exercise releases stress and improves mood; eat well, sleep well and avoid harmful habits.
3. **Relaxation techniques:** Deep breathing, meditation and yoga.
4. **Talk to someone:** Share your problems with a friend, family member or counsellor.
5. **Positive thinking:** Focus on solutions, not just problems. Example: for exam stress, make a study timetable and take short breaks.

Q15.

A **group discussion (GD)** is a structured conversation in which participants express their ideas and opinions on a given topic within a time limit.

1. **Topic and thinking time:** The topic is given (current affairs, abstract or case-based) and participants get time to think.
2. **Discussion:** The discussion begins and each member contributes, without interrupting others.
3. **Conclusion and feedback:** The group may try to reach a conclusion, and observers or evaluators give feedback.
4. **Evaluation – content and communication:** The quality of ideas, and clear and confident speaking.
5. **Evaluation – team, body language and time:** Team coordination, body language and time management.

Q16.

1. **Dress code for interviews:** Clean, ironed formal clothes: formal shirt, trousers and shoes for men; formal suit, kurti or saree for women; minimal accessories and light perfume.
2. **Personal grooming:** Regular bathing and deodorant, clean trimmed nails and neat hair, no excessive make-up or jewellery, and polished shoes with well-fitted clothes.
3. **Personal branding:** How you present yourself in public, including your dress, behaviour and online image.
4. **Table manners – do's:** Sit upright without elbows on the table, wait for everyone before starting, use cutlery properly, chew with your mouth closed and say "excuse me" before leaving.
5. **Table manners – don'ts:** Don't talk with food in your mouth, don't make noise while eating and don't use your phone at the table; respect the eating habits of other cultures.

Q17.

1. **Communication and body language:** Speak clearly, maintain eye contact and keep a good posture.
2. **Listening and understanding questions:** Listen carefully and answer exactly what is asked.
3. **Clarity of thought and confidence:** Give logical, honest answers with confidence.
4. **Knowledge of the subject and company:** Know your subject and research the company and the job role.
5. **Planning and professional conduct:** Prepare answers to common questions, practise mock interviews, dress properly and be punctual.

Q18.

A **behavioural interview** focuses on the candidate's past experiences and actions, and such questions are best answered with the STAR technique.

1. **Situation:** Describe the background. Example: "In our college fest, our team had only two days to find sponsors."
2. **Task:** Explain your responsibility: "I had to raise Rs. 20,000 in sponsorship."
3. **Action:** Explain what you did: "I divided the shops among four members and prepared a short pitch."
4. **Result:** Give the outcome: "We raised Rs. 25,000 and the fest ran on time."
5. **Preparation:** Prepare 3-4 such stories for common questions (teamwork, a problem solved, a failure) and practise them in mock interviews.